dream of a time

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/89554341.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Mantenna (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Child!Adora

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2026-07-30 Words: 481 Chapters: 1/1

dream of a time

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/89554341.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Mantenna (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Child!Adora

Language:
English

Stats:
Published: 2026-07-30 Words: 481 Chapters: 1/1

dream of a time

by forthehonorr

Summary

Adora is bad at spelling lessons. She knows it from how Force Captain Mantenna rubs his bald head in aggravation whenever she gives her paper back. She can't help that words don't come as naturally to her. Pictures do.

(Or, an analysis of Child!Adora being an alien and accidentally bilingual)

Notes

I needed to get this out on a page before I lost my mind. I know there's my other WIPs but...Let me have this...

Adora is good at a lot of things. Shadow Weaver says so. She's good at running *really* fast, good at being quiet when she's supposed to, and good at counting *all the way* up to 50!

"Adora," Captain Mantenna rubbed his forehead and sighed. He did that a lot. Especially around Adora, and especially when it came time for writing and vocabulary.

She hated it. It made her feel stupid. And she *wasn't* stupid.

"How many times do I have to tell you to stop drawing pictures?" He scolded.

"I wasn't!" Adora shrunk her shoulders, cringing at her own backtalk. But it was true! "I wasn't drawing pictures this time, honest!"

"Then how do you explain this?" He turned the page and showed her.

Her worksheet was almost complete, and she'd done it exactly the way he'd told her to! She even spelled the hard words right, like 'Capitan' and 'Sqaud'! At least she thought so. But she *hadn't* been drawing pictures!

She wished Catra were here so she could claw one of Captain Mantenna’s big bulbous eyes like she'd done to Octavia-No she didn't. That was bad. She didn't mean that.

“I wasn't!” She reiterated, crossing her arms. She resisted the urge to stamp her foot. That was for babies, and she was 8 ½ now.

One of Captain Mantenna's boney red fingers pointed to the very top of the page, above where she was sure she had spelled ‘Lord Horbak’ right and-! There it was.

Any protest Adora had died in her throat and she sank into her chair.

Where she was supposed to have written her name was another drawing. Another *stupid* drawing.

It was a diagonal line ending with two dots, with two smaller squiggles on either side that ended with dots. Below, connected by more lines, there was a large triangle, circle and a trapezoid with a self-satisfied dot in the middle. It glared at her from the top of the page and Adora glared right back, as if that would make it disappear.

“I didn't mean to…” She whimpered. Embarrassment was hot on her face, and it made her hands feel sweaty and clammy where she still gripped her pencil.

The force captain sighed *again* and a new wave of shame washed over her. He narrowed his big yellow eyes at her and slid the paper across the desk to her.

"Write it again." He urged. His voice was reedy, but commanding.

"Yes sir!" She straightened into a practiced salute, albeit a seated one.

Carefully, she erased the offending picture, dusting the eraser shavings off the page, she stole a glance upward. His eyes were still on her. Slowly, she leaned down and started to write her name. A…D…O…R…A! She took a moment to admire her handiwork. It was perfect. Just like Shadow Weaver showed her. Just like *she* had to be.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!